Paid Arguments in Favor

Social housing is permanently affordable, community owned, mixed-income housing that's designed to stay off the speculative market—giving working San Franciscans stable homes at rents they can actually afford, for generations.

One of the major impediments to actually building social housing is the cost of borrowing. A Public Bank would be an excellent tool to provide reasonable loans to help build the housing San Francisco families desperately need.

Join social housing advocates and vote Yes on B!

San Franciscans for Social Housing
sfsocialhousing.org

Dylan Hirsch-Shell, Co-founder
Honest Charley Bodkin, Co-founder

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Dylan Hirsch-Shell.

Passing Prop B is a prudent measure that provides key options to the city without wasting taxpayer money

Right now, San Francisco has a unique opportunity to take advantage of a state law allowing municipalities to establish Public Banks, by passing Prop B. Public Banks are a useful tool to help build affordable housing, invest in green infrastructure, and support our small businesses. If San Francisco ever wants to be able to capitalize on the benefits that a Public Bank brings, the best thing to do is pass Prop B this year. Public Banks are a fiscally responsible way to make the most efficient use of taxpayer money. A public bank can help reduce pressure to raise taxes and issue bonds by providing steady, long term financing for core public infrastructure.

Prop B is not a tax and will not result in additional costs for The City.

Malia M. Cohen, California State Controller
Matt Haney, Assemblymember
Rafael Mandelman, President, San Francisco Board of Supervisors
Myrna Melgar, Supervisor
Matt Dorsey, Supervisor
Bilal Mahmood, Supervisor

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

Prop B is the thoughtful, safe, and fiscally responsible way to create a public bank

Public banks solve many problems and provide tremendous value for communities across the world. 25% of the world's banking assets are held in public banks because they work well at reinvesting public funds to support development. But in order to deliver these massive benefits they must remain politically independent and committed to fiscal responsibility. Prop B ensures that our public bank is established with robust governance and best practices.

Prop B requires that our Public Bank

- Has an independent board of directors who make all key decisions.
- Has an oversight committee with appointments spread across elected offices.
- Has multiple safeguards to ensure no single politician can exercise influence on lending decisions.
- Be run by professional bankers working for the people of San Francisco, not politicians.
- Partner with experts in local finance: local credit unions, Community Development Financial Institutions (CDFIs), and community banks.

Prop B creates a Public Bank that all San Franciscans can trust.

The San Francisco Foundation
San Francisco Public Bank Coalition
Malia M. Cohen, California State Controller

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

SF small businesses say vote Yes on B!

Small businesses are the backbone of our city. We represent your favorite restaurants and bars, laundromats and pet stores, grocers and retailers.

But running a business in San Francisco is hard, and dealing with big banks who don't care about small businesses makes it harder.

The Public Bank created by Prop B will provide affordable loans and replace the predatory lending and personal credit card debt small business owners too often must use to pay staff and keep the lights on in tough times.

San Francisco's Small Businesses say Yes on B.

Arguments are the opinions of the authors and have not been checked for accuracy by any official agency.
Arguments are printed as submitted. Spelling and grammatical errors have not been corrected.

Small Business Forward
Sensitive Vintage
Ritual Coffee
Lynne Angel, Owner, El Rio
Justin Dolezaal, Co-Owner, Bar Part Time
Nicholas Parker, Owner, Mercury Cafe
Dontaye Ball, Owner, Gumbo Social
Dianne Ramirez, Owner, Bangin Hair Salon
Sean Mabry, Co-Owner, Mothership
Yolanda Porrata, Owner, Vera Skin Studio
Isabella Hill, Co-Owner, Happy House
Julian Ensworth, Managing Partner, Horsies Bar
Jasjit Ahluwalia, Owner, The Laundry Corner

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

Protect our environment and fight climate change. Vote Yes on B

San Franciscans want to address the existential threat of climate change and a legacy of environmental racism. But will the city follow through? Wall Street banks are not going to provide that kind of funding, as they double down on financing fossil fuels under Trump.

A public bank can provide loans to unlock green energy, EV charging, toxic waste cleanups, and more.

SF is a leader in environmental sustainability. The City's Climate Action Plan commits us to bold goals, and recommends a public green bank as a way to achieve them.

Vote Yes on B to stand up for the environment.

350 San Francisco Action
San Francisco League of Conservation Voters
San Francisco Climate Emergency Coalition
SF Policy Action Team / Climate Reality Project
Marie Harrison Community Foundation
Edward Wright, BART Board Vice President

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

If we want more affordable housing, we need Prop B

Rents are skyrocketing in San Francisco, it's a crisis and it's time to bring every tool in the toolkit forward to make this city a place where everyone can thrive.

17,000+ affordable housing units have been approved in San Francisco, but cannot be built because there is no funding. A Public Bank will be a critical tool to help provide that financing, so we can build the affordable housing that San Francisco families desperately need.

The bank can provide loans at more affordable terms than Wall Street banks, can help acquire and preserve affordable housing, and provide flexible gap financing to unlock stalled projects and maximize San Francisco's housing opportunities.

Join us and vote Yes on B!

San Francisco Tenants Union
Council of Community Housing Organizations
San Francisco Community Land Trust
San Francisco Senior and Disability Action
San Francisco Anti-Displacement Coalition
Affordable Housing Alliance
Race and Equity in All Planning Coalition - San Francisco
The Housing Rights Committee of San Francisco

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

Working families in San Francisco need Prop B.

A Public Bank will be a huge benefit for the workers who keep San Francisco going. The bank can provide loans to build workforce housing, and the infrastructure and housing projects it funds will provide good paying jobs during construction and after completion.

A Public Bank can provide badly needed financing for our streets, transit, and other public projects.

Prop B also protects workers by ensuring that companies with a history of labor law violations will not be eligible for loans.

Join workers and vote Yes on B.

SF Labor Council
National Union of Healthcare Workers
United Educators of San Francisco

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

For a fair and equitable San Francisco, vote Yes on B

The long and ugly history of discrimination by private banks against minority communities is well known. From mortgage loans, to small business loans, we have seen time and again that Wall Street banks have routinely and repeatedly denied us opportunity based on race.

A public bank, with a public, independent board of directors, will help our communities access the loans we need to afford to stay in our homes, keep our small businesses running, and finally make the investments in our communities that have long been denied for racist reasons.

Faith in Action
San Francisco Latino Task Force
Coleman Advocates for Children and Youth
South of Market Community Action Network (SOMCAN)
La Raza Community Resource Center
People Organizing to Demand Environmental and Economic Rights (PODER)
Marie Harrison Community Foundation
Race and Equity in All Planning Coalition - San Francisco (REP-SF)
Archbishop Franzo King
Reverend Norman Fong
Shamann Walton, Supervisor
Chyanne Chen, Supervisor
John Avalos, Former Supervisor

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

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Prop B is the culmination of years of rigorous work:

- In 2017 the San Francisco Public Bank Coalition was founded.
- In 2019, the California State Assembly successfully passed AB 857, the California Public Banking Act, creating **a formal pathway for local jurisdictions** to charter their own public banks to save money, strengthen our local economies, support community economic development, and address our critical infrastructure and housing needs.
- In 2021, the Board of Supervisors passed an ordinance establishing **the San Francisco Reinvestment Working Group** to oversee the formation of a business and governance plan, consisting of the Controller, Treasurer, and technical experts in financial institutions, affordable housing financing, small business lending, environmental justice, and renewable energy.
- The Reinvestment Working Group hired an experienced banking consultant who has started over 100 banks and worked with them to prepare a **Final Governance Plan, Business Plan, and Viability Study for a San Francisco Municipal Financial Corporation and a San Francisco Public Bank**, which were accepted by the Board of Supervisors in 2023.

The years of rigorous work by city leaders across the political spectrum and movement work by advocates have produced this thoroughly vetted plan for a successful Public Bank that forms the basis of this Charter Amendment.

Art Agnos, Former Mayor
Tom Ammiano, Former Assemblymember
Aaron Peskin, Former President, Board of Supervisors
David Campos, Former Supervisor
Sandra Lee Fewer, Former Supervisor
Jane Kim, Former Supervisor
Eric Mar, Former Supervisor
Gordon Mar, Former Supervisor
Hillary Ronen, Former Supervisor
Edward Wright, BART Board Vice President
Peter Gallotta, SFDCCC Member
Michael Nguyen, SFDCCC Member
Gary McCoy, Former Political Director, Speaker Emerita Pelosi

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

Prop B keeps San Francisco's money working for San Franciscans

San Francisco residents and businesses pay billions of dollars in taxes every year.

Prop B is NOT a tax, and will not raise taxes. It simply provides an option to keep our money here, working for us, rather than in multinational mega banks.

The Public Bank will be equipped to help make home ownership more affordable for SF families, keep our beloved small businesses stable in our neighborhoods, and make the investments we need to protect San Francisco from climate chaos.

The Public Bank will help the city manage taxpayer money efficiently.

Your neighbors say Yes on B!

Westside Forward
Haight Ashbury Neighborhood Council

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Arguments are printed as submitted. Spelling and grammatical errors have not been corrected.

Richmond District Democratic Club
Excelsior Strong
*Stephen Torres, LGBTQ Small Business & Worker Advocate**
*Leah LaCroix, President San Francisco District 11 Democratic Club**
JR Eppler
DJ Brookter

*For identification purposes only; author is signing as an individual and not on behalf of an organization.

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Yes on B, Our City Our Bank.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

Stand up to big Wall Street banks by passing Prop B

Private, multinational mega banks, whose only motivation is shareholder profit, will never be aligned with the priorities of San Franciscans – the things we need to make the city more affordable: building and preserving affordable housing, converting the city to green energy, providing jobs for workers, and supporting local co-ops. That is why we must form a Public Bank in San Francisco – a bank that puts the people's needs first.

Private corporate banks have supercharged fossil fuel financing under Trump and shamelessly abandoned their climate goals.

They finance war, genocide, and destruction.

They make record profits while workers scrape by and starve.

Enough is enough! The time for a Public Bank is now.

Democratic Socialists of America – San Francisco
Indivisible SF
Jackie Fielder, Supervisor
Jane Kim, Former Supervisor
Dean Preston, Former Supervisor
John Avalos, Former Supervisor

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Prop B makes sure our money won't be used to fund war, oil, or tobacco

The purpose of the Public Bank is to fund and support projects that benefit the people of San Francisco. That is why it is so crucial that Prop B prohibits any Public Bank loans or support for weapons manufacturing, fossil fuel extraction and refinement, or promotion of tobacco products. Wall Street Banks eagerly lend to the destruction of our planet and its people, it's important San Francisco have an alternative to our deposits financing death and destruction.

Prop B keeps our money working for the common good.

Indivisible SF
*Reid Coggins, Co-President, Harvey Milk LGBTQ Democratic Club**
*Ajai Nicole Duncan, Co-President, Harvey Milk LGBTQ Democratic Club**
John Avalos, Former Supervisor
Eric Mar, Former Supervisor

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The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

Set the next generations of San Franciscans up for success. Vote Yes on B

Young people who want to stay in San Francisco need housing we can afford, and a planet that we can live on. A Public Bank is crucial for funding affordable housing and affordable homeownership, as well as providing loans for green energy and sustainable infrastructure projects for decades to come.

Yes on B!

Evolve California
*Andrea Gallardo Lopez, Co-President, San Francisco Young Democrats**
*Ernesto Cuellar, Co-President, San Francisco Young Democrats**

*For identification purposes only; author is signing as an individual and not on behalf of an organization.

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The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. The San Francisco Foundation, 2. Christin Evans, 3. National Union of Healthcare Workers.

No Paid Arguments Against Proposition B Were Submitted